

Aspects of Reuse in the Royal Necropolis of Tanis

جوانب من إعادة الاستخدام في الجبانة الملكية في تانيس

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Abstract: The political capital of Egypt shifted from Thebes to Pi-Ramesses during the reign of Ramesses II for political and military reasons until the kings of the 21st Dynasty established Tanis as the new capital. Interestingly, most of Tanis's structures consist of reused monuments from Pi-Ramesses. The extensive reuse of stone appears puzzling, given the wealth of the 21st Dynasty. Oddly, they could not provide stones for their masonries and necropolis, nor did they quarry suitable sarcophagi. Despite their affluence, the kings of the 22nd Dynasty reused the royal necropolis of Tanis, even though they had built Bubastis as their new capital. Building on this context, this study aims to analyze the reuse policies of the kings of the 21st and 22nd Dynasties in Tanis in general and its royal necropolis in particular, and to explain it politically and economically by tracking the quarrying activities and to investigate the reasons of (re-)burring the Bubastite kings in the royal necropolis of Tanis and assessing whether ideological motivations for reuse were plausible.

Keywords: Tanis, Royal necropolis, Reuse, Sarcophagi, Psusennes I, Shoshenq I.

الملخص: انتقلت عاصمة مصر السياسية من طيبة إلى بر- رعمسيس أثناء حكم الملك رمسيس الثاني لظروف سياسية وعسكرية بحتة إلى أن قام ملوك الأسرة الحادية والعشرين المحلية ببناء عاصمة جديدة في الدلتا وهي تانيس. تم تأسيس معظم المنشآت المعمارية في تانيس وكذلك جبانته بأحجار معاد استخدامها أكثرها من أطلال بر- رعمسيس. على الرغم من الثراء الملحوظ لملوك تانيس إلا أنهم قاموا بأنشطة إعادة استخدام الآثار القديمة لأنهم لم يستطيعوا توفير أحجار لبناء الجبانة أو حتى قطع توابيت مناسبة لهم، والأغرب أن بعض ملوك الأسرة الثانية والعشرين القوية والغنية قاموا بإعادة استخدام جبانة تانيس الملكية والدفن بها على الرغم من أنهم قاموا بتشيد عاصمة أخرى هي تل بسطة. وبناء على ما سبق تهدف هذه الدراسة إلى تحليل سياسة إعادة الاستخدام التي اتبعها ملوك الأسرتين الحادية والعشرين والثانية والعشرين والتي ظهرت بشدة في تانيس وبخاصة جبانته الملكية، وتفسير ذلك سياسياً واقتصادياً من خلال تتبع أنشطة التحجير أثناء فترة هاتين الأسرتين، ومحاولة تبرير أسباب (إعادة) دفن ملوك الأسرة اليوباسطية في جبانة تانيس الملكية، ومناقشة ما إذا كان السبب الأيدلوجي لإعادة الاستخدام مقنع أم لا.

الكلمات الدالة: تانيس، الجبانة الملكية، إعادة الاستخدام، توابيت حجرية، بسوسنيس الأول، شيشنق الأول.

1. Introduction

There is evidence for royal activities in the area that would become known as Pi-Ramesses, modern Qantir, during the reigns of Horemheb and Seti I. The political situation during the reign of Ramesses II prompted him to move the capital to the eastern Delta, and so Pi-Ramesses was born. Ramesses II launched a massive construction project befitting his new capital in the north, parallel to Thebes in the south.¹ A sharp reduction in the water levels in the Pelusiac branch of the Nile would certainly have

¹ Gilli, Barbara, "How to Build a Capital: The Second Life of Pre-Ramesside Materials in Pi-Ramesses", in Franzmeier, Henning, *et al.* (eds.) *Mit Archäologischen Schichten Geschichte schreiben: Festschrift für Edgar B. Pusch zum 70. Geburtstag*: Gmbh & Co., 2016, 139.

resulted in a blockage of the waterway for shipping. The consequence of the river silting up during the 19th and 20th dynasties was probably the reason for relocating the Delta residence to a convenient harbor location, which became Tanis, modern San el-Hagar.¹

2. Tanis the Heiress

Kitchen suggested that Pi-Ramesses was abandoned before the new 21st Dynasty took power, i.e., when Ramesses VIII made a dedication to Seth, the lord of Avaris, not Seth of Pi-Ramesses anymore.² Pi-Ramesses was abandoned as a royal residence, and its extensive ruins were technically easily accessible and became an ideal stone quarrying area. The new capital of the 21st Dynasty, Tanis, desperately needed quarries for its large building projects; the same scenario happened for Bubastis, the capital of the 22nd Dynasty.³ Pi-Ramesses was simply deprived of its major monuments after being a convenient quarry. Consequently, the Ramesside monuments were principally recycled as scrap stone to build Tanis; therefore, the modern explorers were deceived into suggesting that Tanis had for a time been called Pi-Ramesses, but in fact, Tanis never ever bore the name Pi-Ramesses.⁴

3. The Ideology of Reuse

One of the most notable features observed throughout the history of ancient Egyptian architecture is the use of poorer and older materials of irregular blocks or even rubble for the core and foundation of structures with an outer case made of refined and higher-quality stones.⁵ These widespread practices of reuse were frequently employed to avoid wasting materials and to save the cost and effort typically associated with cutting in quarries and transportation.

The motivation for reuse can be attributed to a multitude of reasons, including economic considerations such as the accessibility of construction materials and the simplicity of their extraction.⁶ Ideologically, the reuse of older monuments dedicated to royal ancestors in new construction was to legitimize the new kings and to confirm the link with the predecessor monarchs.

¹ Bietak, Manfred, *Tell El-Dab'a II*, Wien: Österreichischen Akademie der Wissenschaften, 1975, 32.

² Kitchen, Kenneth Anderson, *On the Reliability of the Old Testament*, Michigan: William B. Eerdmans Publishing Company, 2003, 256.

³ Bietak, *Tell El-Dab'a II*, 32.

⁴ Kitchen, *On the Reliability of the Old Testament*, 255-256.

⁵ Arnold, Dieter, *Building in Egypt: Pharaonic Stone Masonry*, New York: Oxford University Press, 1991, 148.

⁶ For the Architectural reuse in the Egyptian royal ideology see Silva, Luiza Osorio, "Out of Ruins: Contextualizing an Ancient Egyptian Spectacle of Architectural Reuse", *Cambridge Archaeological Journal*, 2023, 1-3. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0959774322000452>

Reuse practices observed in Tanis were executed in a variety of ways. In some instances, the original inscriptions were erased to make new ones. In other cases, the inscriptions were not erased, and the other side of the stonework was utilized to make new inscriptions. A third way involved the preservation of older inscriptions without adding new ones; these elements may have been used for filling the walls or employed in a portion of a wall, or the block was rotated to use one of the unadorned sides as the visible face.¹

4. Recycled Legacy of Stones

In most cases, it is impossible to trace with certainty the origin or the owner of a reused stonework in Tanis that became the new owner of Pi-Ramesses' legacy which was essentially reused pieces that could have come from anywhere as the Ramesside kings controlled all of Egypt.² On the other hand, the Tanite kings, whose authority was limited to the Delta, did not have access to any quarry; thereby the economic solutions were few or almost exclusively limited to the Pi-Ramesses' wealth of stones, which we do not know the origin of many of its reused monuments. It is noteworthy that some monuments of Tanis have been reused, as indicated by inscriptions that originate from the Hyksosian Avaris³, the oldest capital in this region and beyond. In short, the foundation of each capital in the Delta was constructed upon reused monuments of previous one(s). Monuments such as obelisks, sarcophagi, false doors, and even colossi were reused or recycled as building materials in new constructions.⁴ In numerous instances, the original inscriptions and decorations were erased. Consequently, the identity of the item's original owner remains unknown. Moreover, a considerable number of the statuary of Tanis have essentially been reused, primarily by Ramesses II, the original inscriptions have been entirely obliterated and replaced by new decoration, which was implemented during his reign.⁵ The Ramesside kings ruled over all of Egypt.

4.1. Tombs Made of Reused Blocks

The royal necropolis complex was constructed within the main precinct of the temple of Amun in Tanis. The kings of the 21st and 22nd Dynasties were buried in modest tombs unearthed in 1939-1940 by Pierre Montet. Upon initial observation of the necropolis' constructions, it becomes evident that the stones are not original but have been reused

¹ Gilli, "How to Build a Capital: The Second Life of Pre-Ramesside Materials in Pi-Ramesses", 142-144, 146.

² Gilli, "How to Build a Capital: The Second Life of Pre-Ramesside Materials in Pi-Ramesses", 167.

³ Bietak, *Tell El-Dab'a* II, 32.

⁴ Mostly listed in Uphill, Eric, *The Temples of Per Ramesses*, Warminster: Aris & Phillips, 1984, 8 ff.

⁵ Gilli, "How to Build a Capital: The Second Life of Pre-Ramesside Materials in Pi-Ramesses", 143; Montet, Pierre, *Tanis Douze Années de Fouilles dans une Capitale Oubliée du Delta Égyptien*, Paris: Payot, 1942, 61.

from other buildings. The dimensions and asymmetry of the blocks provide compelling evidence that they underwent a process of recycling or repurposing. Unfortunately, their original functions and owners for only a few examples are known. For instance, a slab was cut from an OK or a MK statue to reuse it as an architrave for Ramesses II; this slab was subsequently reused again as a ceiling slab in the tomb of Osorkon II.¹ Additionally, three limestone blocks back to the OK or MK were reused in the tomb of Shoshenq III.²

4.2. Tombs Reuse

Only seven tombs for the kings of the 21st and 22nd Dynasties were found in the royal necropolis of Tanis (see **Table 1**), with a notable absence of Smendes³ and Amenemnisu of the 21st Dynasty, Shoshenq I⁴ and Osorkon I⁵ of the 22nd Dynasty. Interestingly, burials of a non-royal figure were found in the royal necropolis, i.e., the general Wendjebauendjed, the high official in the court of Psusennes I who may have functioned as the king's deputy in Amun's cult in Tanis, whose burial was in an outer chamber in the tomb of his king in NRT-III.⁶ He possibly died after Psusennes I and reuse his king's tomb and was buried next to him, as it is unlikely he died during the king's lifetime.

¹ Montet, Pierre, *La Nécropole Royale de Tanis I: Les constructions et le tombeau d'Osorkon II à Tanis*, Paris, 1947, 52, fig. 13, pl. XIV.

² Montet, *Nécropole Royale III*, 78, no. 1-2, 79, no. 6, pl. XLIII.

³ The burial of Smendes in Tanis may be attested by one of his canopic jars preserved in the Metropolitan Museum no. 47.60, which was found in Tanis or nearby; see Dodson, Aidan, *The Canopic Equipment of The Kings of Egypt*, London: Kegan Paul International, 1994, 79, pl. XXXII-XXXIII [a]; text in Jansen-Winkel, Karl, *Inschriften der Spätzeit I: die 21. Dynasty*, Wiesbaden: Harrassowitz Verlag, 2007, 1. It is possible that he was buried in NRT-I which was later appropriated to Osorkon II of the 22nd Dynasty. The north wall of NRT-III of Psusennes I, the earliest known king discovered in the necropolis, had been cut back to accommodate part of an older tomb, i.e., NRT-I which means the latter is the oldest tomb in the royal necropolis of Tanis, and it belonged to a former king of Psusennes I, who might be Smendes, Dodson, Aidan "Some Notes Concerning the Royal Tombs at Tanis", *CdÉ* 63, 1988, 221-223.

⁴ The burial place of Shoshenq I is unknown. The only information available about his burial is the canopic chest in the Egyptian Museum (Neues Museum) of Berlin ÄMB 11000. Fragments of two canopic jars from NRT-V of Shoshenq III have usually been ascribed to Shoshenq I, Dodson, *Canopic Equipment*, 83-4, pl. XXXVII-XXXVIII, XLIII [b].

⁵ Few remains of Osorkon I's burial were discovered in the burial chamber of Takelot I in NRT-I. These include a gold bracelet JE 72199 and an alabaster jar JE 86962 in the Egyptian Museum; see Aston, David, "Takeloth II: A King of the Theban 23rd Dynasty?", *JEA* 75, 1989, 143-144. This may indicate that he was buried there or that Takelot I reused some of his father's funerary equipment. Furthermore, Shoshenq V was also subsequently buried in NRT I as evidenced by his canopic equipment, Dodson, *Canopic Equipment*, 96.

⁶ Kitchen, Kenneth Anderson, *The Third Intermediate Period in Egypt: 1100-650 BC*, Warminster: Aris and Phillips, 1996, § 222.

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Surprisingly, two princes were attested, an empty sarcophagus of (Ramesses-) Ankhefenmut was found in NRT-III; he was a son of Psusennes I and predeceased him, so he was buried in his father's tomb.¹ The second Prince is Hornakht, Osorkon II's youngest son. He was a titular HPA, apparently for the royal residence in Tanis itself.²

Table (1): The royal tombs, original owners, and later occupants

Tomb no	of	Dynasty	Other occupants	Dynasty
NRT-I	Smendes (?)	21 st (?)	Prince Hornakht	22 nd
			Osorkon I (?)	22 nd
	Osorkon II	22 nd	Takelot I	22 nd
			Shoshenq V (?)	22 nd
NRT-II	Pami	22 nd	—	—
NRT-III	Psusennes I	21 st	Wendjebauendjed	21 st
			Prince Ankhefenmut	21 st
			Amenemope	21 st
			Siamun	21 st
			Psusennes II	21 st
			Shoshenq II	21 st
NRT-IV	Amenemope	21 st	—	—
NRT-V	Shoshenq III	22 nd	Shoshenq IV	22 nd
NRT-VI	?	21 st /22 nd	—	—
NRT-VII	?	22 nd	—	—

The kings of the 22nd Dynasty moved the capital to Bubastis, and logically the royal necropolis as well, but it is surprising that the Tanite necropolis contains evidence of many Bubastite kings. To find out why, we should start with the remains of Shoshenq II. The mummy of Shoshenq II was placed in a hawk-headed silver coffin in NRT-III in a condition that confirms the presence of water, and accordingly, roots grew on some of its parts, which implies that the king's original tomb had been flooded for a long time and that roots could have penetrated the coffin itself.³ No trace of water was found in NRT-III, which may indicate that this tomb is not the original tomb of Shoshenq II, and we can see that the silver coffin was partially damaged as a result of a reburial activity.⁴

The events may have unfolded as follows: Osorkon II, or less likely Takelot I, found out about the flooding of the new Bubastite royal necropolis, so he had to rebury Shoshenq II as quickly as possible; building a new tomb was not the best idea, but reusing

¹ Kitchen, *Third Intermediate Period*, § 41.

² Kitchen, *Third Intermediate Period*, § 282.

³ Derry, Douglas, "Note on the Remains of Shashanq", *ASAE* 39, 1939, 549.

⁴ More discussions about other archaeological evidence in Dodson, *Canopic Equipment*, 89.

the old necropolis of Tanis was. He chose an antechamber in NRT-III of Psusennes I as the final residence of Shoshenq II. Osorkon II decided to rebury his father, Takelot I, in NRT-I of Smendes (?), and possibly Osorkon I as well, who may have faced the same fate as Shoshenq II, and then he chose NRT-I for his own burial.

4.3. Sarcophagi Reuse

Despite the evident affluence observed in the royal burials of the 21st and 22nd Dynasties, it is notable that all the extant sarcophagi utilized by the Tanite kings down to the middle of the 22nd Dynasty were, in fact, reused pieces. Thirteen sarcophagi were discovered in the royal necropolis of Tanis, most of them were reused, and all the original inscriptions were erased. In some cases, they were not even sarcophagi at all but they had been adapted to serve as lids¹ reviewed in (Table 2) as follows:

Table (2): Sarcophagi found in the Tanite royal necropolis

no	of	NRT-	Lid and coffer		Original owner	Period	Original location
			Matches	Differs			
1	Psusennes I	III	Red granite	×	Merneptah	19 th Dyn.	Valley of the Kings
2	Psusennes I	III	Black granite	×	?	19 th Dyn.	Valley of the Kings
3	Ankhefenmut	III	×	basalt & red granite	?	—	—
4	Wendjebauendjed	III	Granite	×	Amenhotep	NK	West Thebes
5	Amenemope	III	Black granite	×	Mutnedjmet	21 st Dyn.	Tanis
6	Amenemope	IV	×	granite & fine sandstone	?	Lid= OK	Memphis (?)
7	Takelot I	I	Fine sandstone	×	Ameny	MK	Fayoum
8	Osorkon II	I	Red granite	×	—	Lid= 19 th Dyn.	Lid= Pi-Ramesses
9	Hornakht	I	×	Sandstone & Red granite	?	OK	?
10	Shoshenq III	V	Granite	×	—	Lid= 13 th Dyn.	Lid=?
11	Shoshenq IV	V	No lid, and the coffer is made of granite		—	—	—
12	?	II	Limestone	×	—	Lid=?	Lid=?
13	?	I	Red granite	×	—	Lid= 19 th Dyn.	Lid= Pi-Ramesses

¹ Lichtenberg, Roger and Dunand, Françoise, *Mummies and Death in Egypt*, Ithaca: Cornell University Press, 2006, 61.

- Case no. 1:** Originally allocated to Merenptah, four stone sarcophagi were assigned to him; the one mentioned here is the third one, which was reused by Psusennes I to be his outer sarcophagus out of his three sarcophagi assemblage. The sarcophagus lid of this one is a cartouche shaped with a figure of the osirified King Merneptah.¹ This sarcophagus is preserved in the Egyptian Museum JE 87297. The name of Merneptah is inscribed on the knot of the kilt belt; this is the only cartouche that has not been replaced by those of Psusennes I.
- Case no. 2:** The second sarcophagus of Psusennes I and the middle one. An anthropoid sarcophagus in the osirified form. It was dedicated to an unknown king of the 19th Dynasty; the names of the original owner were erased and replaced by the names Psusennes I, now in the Egyptian Museum JE 85911. Inside this sarcophagus, the famous silver coffin of the king was found.²
- Case no. 4:** An anthropoid sarcophagus attributed to the so-called Amenhotep, a Theban third prophet of Amun. The inscriptions were covered with plaster.
- Case no. 5:** This sarcophagus was prepared for Queen Mutnedjmet, the wife of Psusennes I and the assumed mother of Amenemope, located in a chamber on the other side of that of her husband in NRT-III, but Amenemope reused it for his own. The mummy of Amenemope was interred in a gilded wooden coffin in the queen's sarcophagus.³ The lid matches the coffer, but its horizontal cylindrical tenons have been trimmed. Weirdly, he was buried there in NRT-III even though he is the known owner of NRT-IV⁴, but no one was found there.
- Case no. 6:** The granite lid was fashioned from an OK slab. The coffer displays no evidence of reuse, but it may be from the same period too.

¹ Montet, Pierre, *La Nécropole Royale de Tanis II: Les Constructions et le Tombeau de Psousennés à Tanis*, Paris, 1960, 111, pl. LXXVI; Sourouzzian, Hourig, *Les Monuments du Roi Merenptah*, Mainz: Philipp von Zabern, 1989, 180, 182; and further discussions in Ismaeel, Mohamed Hassan, "Context Analysis of Reusing the Royal Mummies' Funeral Equipment", *JARCH* 26, 2023, 369-370.

² Ismaeel, "Context Analysis of Reusing the Royal Mummies' Funeral Equipment", 370.

³ Kitchen, *Third Intermediate Period*, § 229. It is surprising that the remains of the mummy of Amenemope were discovered in NRT-III, even though he is the owner of NRT-IV. This suggests that NRT-IV was his original tomb, but he was later moved and reburied, probably by Siamun, in NRT-III.

⁴ cf. Dodson, *Canopic Equipment*, 80 ff.

- Case no. 7:** The occupant king was wrongly identified with Takelot II by Montet¹, this sarcophagus was moved from Fayoum, of a MK certain Ameny.
- Case no. 8:** The lid was carved roughly from a group statue of Ramesses II. According to the analysis of certain objects including canopic jars and the remains of a hawk-headed coffin, Osorkon II is the owner of this tomb.
- Case no. 9:** The coffer was reused for Hornakht, son of Osorkon II. The inscriptions on the long sides are attributed to the OK, and the end has been trimmed. The lid is reused too, and the feet have been cut off.
- Case no. 10:** The lid was carved from an architrave or lintel that was inscribed with the names of Sekhemrekhutawy and Hor of the 13th Dynasty.²
- Case no. 11:** The coffer was found empty and without inscription. Several fragments were found in the debris for one or two canopic jars bearing the cartouches of Hedjkheperre Shoshenq.³
- Case no. 12:** The lid was carved into a statue.
- Case no. 13:** The lid was carved into a statue of Ramesses II.

In summary, the sarcophagi were not extracted from quarries exclusively but rather were reused pieces and were originally intended for royal figures or individuals. In some cases, sarcophagi were reused in their original condition or with some modifications (cases nos. 5, 9). In other instances, the material employed for the lid does not match with that used for the coffer (cases nos. 3, 6, 9), or the lid was not a component of another sarcophagus or part of it at all but rather a component of an architectural element (cases nos. 6, 10), or even a part of a statue (cases nos. 8, 12, 13).

5. Funerary Equipment Reuse

The practices of reuse were not limited to architectural elements; portable objects were also subject to these activities. Two notable artifacts are of particular interest in this regard; both were found in NRT-III in the burial of Psusennes I as follows:

- a. A stove or brazier of Ramesses II: now in the Egyptian Museum JE 85910⁴, originally made for the Sed festival of Ramesses II and deposited in a palace or a

¹ cf. Jansen-Winkel, Karl, "Thronname und Begräbnis Takeloth I", *Varia Aegyptica* 3, 1987, 253-258; and Aston, "Takeloth II: A King of the Theban 23rd Dynasty?", 139-153.

² Montet, *Nécropole Royale* III, 71-73, pl. XXVIII.

³ Dodson, Aidan, "A New King Shoshenq Confirmed?", *GM* 137, 1993, 54-55.

⁴ Further details in Pino, Cristina, "Bronze Brazier from the Tomb of Psusennes: Egyptian Museum Cairo, JE 85910", in Eldamaty, Mamdouh Trad, Mai (eds.) *Egyptian Museum Collections Around the World I*, Cairo: AUC press, 2002, 957-965.

temple in Thebes or in the vicinity of Tanis and then reused as a sacred artifact and as a token of veneration and respect for this great king and reused as a base for the large libation stand in NRT-III.

- b. A golden ewer of Ahmose I preserved now in the Egyptian Museum JE 85895: Reeves believed that this ewer was a part of the funerary equipment that was prepared for the original burial of Ahmose in West Thebes¹, and that it was reused after the inspection teams at the royal necropolis reburied the king after the great tomb robberies. This seems logical to me and strongly supported by the only known reburial docket of Ahmose I on his wrappings, which mentions that this took place during the eighth year of Psusennes I.²

Many other examples of reused funerary equipment were found in the royal necropolis of Tanis. For instance, the sarcophagus of Queen Mutnedjmet reused by Amenemope in NRT-III as mentioned above (Table 2: no. 5); canopic jars derived from NRT-III belonging to General Wendjebauendjed may represent reused items³; a human-headed MK canopic jar found in NRT-V was indeed part of the funerary equipment of Shoshenq III.⁴ Many reused pieces were found in the burial of Prince Hornakht, e.g., quartzite canopic chest back to the MK⁵ it was long considered a container for the prince's canopic jars; however, the fact that it was found in a secondary context suggests that it was reused as a building material when the burial chamber was extended to accommodate Hornakht⁶; objects inscribed with the name of Amenemope⁷; and a scarab of Amenhotep III.⁸

6. Analyzing the Evidence

The conflicting data that came out of the Tanite royal necropolis is very confusing: great quantities of golden artifacts and silver coffins on one hand and humble tombs made of recycled blocks to contain reused sarcophagi on the other. Is this a reflection of extreme wealth or of a collapsed economy? It is not possible to make a judgment according to the styles of construction, nor can one ignore the number of precious metals found in the royal necropolis, i.e., 30kg of gold in jewelry and various objects, in addition to 100kg of silver for the coffin (now in the Egyptian Museum JE 85912) and vessels for Psusennes I, and 20kg of gold in jewels and 100kg of silver for the coffin only for Shoshenq II (now in the Egyptian Museum JE 72154), for the modest Amenemope, all

¹ Reeves, Carl Nicholas, *Valley of the Kings: The Decline of a Royal Necropolis*, London: Kegan Paul International, 1990, 282, footnote 103.

² Maspero, Gaston, "Les Momies Royales de D  ir el-Bahar  ", *MMAF* 1 (4), 1889, 534.

³ Dodson, *Canopic Equipment*, 82.

⁴ Dodson, *Canopic Equipment*, 92.

⁵ Montet, Pierre, *La N  cropole Royale de Tanis I: Les Constructions et le Tombeau de d'Osorkon II    Tanis*, Paris, 1960, 61, fig. 18.

⁶ Dodson, *Canopic Equipment*, 91.

⁷ Montet, *N  cropole Royale II*, 66, fig. 21.

⁸ Montet, *N  cropole Royale I*, 65, fig. 20, no. 84.

the same, a few kilos of gold, at least 5kg of gold and 5kg of silver for Wendjebauendjed.¹

All these evidence raises several questions, such as the logical reasons behind the choice of silver for the coffins of Tanite and Bubastite kings rather than the more traditional golden or gilded options. This question was discussed by Ohshiro, who concluded that Psusennes I used silver under the influence of some prominent Libyan figures within the state or their effective relatives. One such figure was Herihor, who had numerous sons with Libyan names, including Masaharta; furthermore, Masaharta the HPA son of Pinedjem I and the brother of Psusennes I, and that gold was harder to obtain.² This hypothesis is riddled and lacks sufficient evidence to be considered a valid fact. The following points illustrate some gaps:

a. Herihor and Pinedjem I

It is undisputed that Herihor had no blood relationship with the 21st Tanite kings or the HPA-kings in Thebes. Pinedjem I was definitely a son of the HPA Piankh³, and that Pinedjem I's assumed mother is probably Nodjmet.

b. The Lineage of the Theban HPA

The most notable sons of Pinedjem and his wife Princess and later Queen Henuttawy, daughter of Ramesses XI, were Psusennes I, the king in Tanis; the HPA Masaharta; and the HPA Menkheperre⁴ who would become a king in Thebes. So far, there is no evidence of the Libyan race in this series.

c. The Libyan Presence and Influence

Indeed, the Libyan presence in Egypt began to increase starting from the reign of Ramesses III. The Libyan people were Egyptianized over time, and the Libyan effect certainly occurred. Accordingly, there is no reason to assume that someone, e.g., Masaharta (the HPA), would be a Libyan just because of his name, especially in the absence of archaeological evidence and what is stated above about the blood relationship and lineage. If what Ohshiro said about the Libyan influence and traditions were correct,

¹ Guizard, Philippe, "Les Trésors Oubliés de Tanis", *Le Bulletin Académie des Sciences et Lettres de Montpellier*, 9 Février 2015, 52.

² Ohshiro, Michinori, "Why Did King Psusennes I Own a Silver Coffin?", *GM* 262, 2020, 185-190.

³ "... the HPA king of the gods Pinedjem (I), son of the HPA Piankh ..." Clearly attested in the linen reburial docket of Thutmose II, the same formulation in a linen docket of Ramesses III, and in the coffin docket of Amenhotep I as "... the HPA Pinedjem (I) son of Piankh", included in Maspero, "Momies Royales", 545-546, 563-564, 536-537.

⁴ The genealogy of the HPA Pinedjem II, Menkheperre's son and heir, is confirmed by his linen docket, which states: "*The Osiris HPA Pinedjem (II) the justified, son of Menkheperre, the son of King Pinedjem (I) in the front of the ennead*", Maspero, "Momies Royales", 572.

this would fit with the Libyan 22nd Bubastite Dynasty, not with the 21st Tanite kings. Suggesting that the Tanite kings could not obtain gold does not solve the problem but raises more complex questions. The quantity of silver was much greater than that of gold, and silver was highly valued because of its rarity in contrast to gold, in the late 20th Dynasty, the value of silver was worth twice as much as gold.¹

Egypt had no local sources of silver, and it came from elsewhere, either through trade or later as tribute or booty of conquests. Records indicate that in the 18th Dynasty silver was received from the Levant, while in the 19th Dynasty it came from the Levant, from a country to the north of Egypt, and from Libya.² How did the Tanite kings get so much silver? Where did they get it? And how much did they barter for it?

The wealth of the 22nd Dynasty is somewhat acceptable due to the Egyptian presence outside the traditional borders of Egypt³ as evidenced by a series of monuments found in the Levant, especially in Byblos for Shoshenq I⁴, Osorkon I⁵ and II⁶. Accordingly, some of the silver mines were under Egyptian sovereignty.

Another question is how gold and silver were more available than stones. It is very unlikely that the Tanite kings were able to bring silver from foreign countries while they were unable to use local quarries to make appropriate sarcophagi. To find out an answer, we must trace the quarrying activities.

7. Quarrying Activities of the 21st and 22nd Dynasties.

The early kings of the 21st Dynasty were attested in Upper Egyptian documentations, which makes us reconsider the theory of the two parallel states of the 21st Dynasty. Evidence that may tell us about the actual political situation of the state, which is not common among scholars, is that the early kings of the 21st dynasty may have had a possible nominal authority over Egypt including Upper Egypt, e.g., Smendes, and this was attested in the Thebaide. A stela inscribed in the quarry at Dibabieh near Gebelen describes how Smendes, while residing in Memphis, heard of the danger to the Luxor temple from flooding, gave orders for repairs, hence the quarry work, and received news

¹ Černý, Jaroslav, "Prices and Wages in Egypt in the Ramesside Period", *Cahiers d'Histoire Mondiale* I/4, 1954, 905.

² Gale, Noel and Stos-Gale, Zofia, "Ancient Egyptian Silver", *JEA* 67, 1981, 103-104.

³ cf. PM VII, 388.

⁴ Several examples were reviewed in Kitchen, *Old Testament*, 33.

⁵ A statue of Osorkon I was found in Byblos with hieroglyphic inscription and Phoenician text, now in the Louvre Museum AO. 9502, included in Dussaud, René, "Dédicace d'une statue d'Osorkon Ier par Eliba'al, Roi de Byblos", *Syria, Revue d'Art Oriental et d'Archéologie* 6/2, 1925, 101-117; Dunand, Maurice, *Fouilles de Byblos I*, Paris: Librairie Orientaliste Paul Geuthner, 1939, 17-18, no. 1048.

⁶ A statue was also found in Byblos, Dunand, *Fouilles de Byblos I*, 115-116, pl. XLIII, no. 1741.

of the success of the mission.¹ At Thebes itself, Smendes was mentioned in a graffito in a scene of Seti I on the gateway of Tuthmosis I in the precinct of Montu.²

Psusennes I somehow had access to Thebes, and here we must keep in mind his kinship with the HPA-kings in the south, as mentioned above, he was a son of Pinedjem I and a brother to both Masaharta and Menkheperre. Psusennes I's relationship with the south may be confirmed by the sarcophagi in Tanis, some of which were Theban models, i.e., the reused outer sarcophagus of Psusennes I, which belonged to Merneptah and was undoubtedly brought from the Valley of the Kings (Table 2, no. 1); the middle sarcophagus for the same king was a sarcophagus of an unknown king of the 19th dynasty, another example from the Valley of the Kings (Table 2, no. 2); and a sarcophagus of a Theban priest called Amenhotep of the 19th Dynasty, which was reused by Wendjebauendjed, a contemporary general of Psusennes I (Table 2, no. 4).

Further evidence for the early kings of the 21st Dynasty at Thebes is a piece of linen from Bab el-Gasus that states: "King of Upper and Lower Egypt Amenemope, year 49"³, Kitchen believed that 'year 49' is attributed to Psusennes I, during which his son Amenemope served as a coregent.⁴

On the same track, one can observe how both NRT-I, mostly of Smendse, and NRT-III of Psusennes I are distinguished by the presence of granite in the burial chambers within a limestone structure, whereas all the other tombs in the necropolis are constructed solely of limestone. It seems reasonable to posit that the granite was transported from the south exclusively to construct these tombs.

Regarding the quarrying activities of the 22nd Dynasty, there is only one example of Shoshenq I, namely Gebel el-Silsila quarry Stela no. 100. A text of year 21, the highest date of Shoshenq I in the documentation, a record for a massive architectural project at the temple of Amun in the Karnak complex, including a portal and a colonnaded court; now they are the Bubastite portal and the first court, and a new gateway was later incorporated into the later first pylon, which was subsequently built by Nectanebo I.⁵

¹ The text was published in Daressy, Georges, "Les Carrières de Gebelein et le Roi Semendès", *Rec. Trav.* 10, 1888, 133-138; Jansen-Winkel, *Inschriften der Spätzeit* I, 1-3, translation in Breasted, James Henry, *Ancient Records of Egypt* IV, Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1906, 308-309; more recent translation in Ritner, Robert Kriech, *The Libyan Anarchy: Inscriptions from Egypt's Third Intermediate Period*, Atlanta: Society of Biblical Literature, 2009, 101-104.

² Published in Varille, Alexandre, *Karnak I*, le Caire: IFAO, 1943, 36, fig. 26, pl. XCVIII, no. 71; Christophe, Louis-Antoine, *Karnak-Nord III*, le Caire: IFAO, 1951, 77.

³ Daressy, Georges, "Contribution a L'étude De La XXI e Dynastie Égyptienne," *RevArch* Troisième Série 28, 1896, 78.

⁴ Kitchen, *Third Intermediate Period*, § 13 and § 25.

⁵ Caminos, Ricardo, "Gebel Es-Silsilah No. 100", *JEA* 38, 1952, 46-61.

Another problematic aspect is that if we accept the excuses made for the kings of Tanis due to the political situation of the divided state, the reuse policy of the wealthy Bubastite kings is unjustified, as their presence in Upper Egypt was proven by archaeological evidence.¹ According to the above and other indications of the 22nd Dynasty's presence in the south, where the quarries with high-quality stones were located, there is no logical reason to explain the absence of any evidence for expeditions launched by Bubastite kings to the quarries to cut suitable sarcophagi for themselves instead of reused ones.

8. The Theban Necropolis, the Same Policy

Egypt fell into a major economic crisis at the end of the 20th Dynasty; the Nubian gold mines were lost at the end of the NK. Thus, the possibility of purchasing high-quality wood from the Levant to make proper coffins became less frequent if it was available at all.² Remarkably, the reuse policy was not only for royal funerary furniture but also for individuals. The British Museum papyrus EA10053 for example contains the thieves' confessions that they stole coffins to reuse them or wood from the temple to make coffins.³ The same scenario of reuse was for the Valley of the Kings and of the Queens to obtain large granite slabs most often from the floors of sarcophagi coffers.⁴ The massive cases were broken up, and many pieces may have been repurposed as raw material for making other monuments such as stelae.⁵ A very interesting case is the sarcophagus of Ramesses II, which was reused by the HPA Menkheperre, then it was fragmented and

¹ Osorkon I, son of Shoshenq I, continued the decoration of his father's colonnade and added three scenes on the Bubastite Portal, after The Epigraphic Survey, *Reliefs and Inscriptions at Karnak III: The Bubastite Portal*, Chicago: The University of Chicago Press, 1954, X, pl. 13-15. A graffito for the same king in the first court of Khonsu temple in the Karnak complex, after The Epigraphic Survey, *The Temple of Khonsu II: Scenes and Inscriptions in the Court and the First Hypostyle Hall*, Chicago: The University of Chicago Press, 1981, 20-21, pl. 134. Osorkon II's activities were largely confined to Thebes almost exclusively, Kitchen, *Third Intermediate Period*, § 278, such as his decree on a Karnak sanctuary block in Vernus, Pascal, "Inscriptions de la Troisième Période Intermédiaire (I)", *BIFAO* 75, 1975, 20-26.

² Hornung, Erik, *The Valley of the Kings: Horizon of Eternity*, New York: Timken publisher, 1990, 47.

³ Cooney, Kathlyn, "Coffin reuse: Ritual Materialism in the Context of Scarcity", in Amenta, Alessia and Guichard, Hélène (eds.), *Proceedings first Vatican Coffin Conference 19-22 June 2013 II*, Vatican: Tipografia Vaticana, 2017, 110.

⁴ Brock, Edwin, "The Tomb of Merenptah and its Sarcophagi", in Reeves, Carl Nicholas (ed.) *After Tut'ankhamun: Research and Excavation in the Royal Necropolis at Thebes*, London: Kegan Paul International, 1992, 133.

⁵ Taylor, John, "Aspects of the History of the Valley of the Kings in the Third Intermediate Period," in Reeves, Carl Nicholas (ed.) *After Tut'ankhamun: Research and Excavation in the Royal Necropolis at Thebes*, London: Kegan Paul International, 1992, 190; Dodson, Aidan "Sarcophagi", in Wilkinson, Richard and Weeks, Kent (eds.) *The Oxford Handbook of the Valley of the Kings*, Oxford: Oxford University press, 2016, 254.

reused again as building material and recently discovered in a Coptic monastery of Apa Moses at Abydos.¹

It is important to note that all the royal mummies were not in their original coffins except for both Seqenenre in his coffin CG 61001 and Thutmose III in his coffin CG 61014, and King Ahmose's ownership of coffin CG 61002 is debatable.² The royal mummies were reburied in reused royal and private coffins, and in several cases, the lid did not match the coffers.³

9. Conclusion

Practices of reuse were common at the end of the NK and afterwards in general, especially in the successive new capitals during the TIP. The severe economic recession that the state was going through caused a severe shortage of materials, which was the actual reason for reuse practices indeed, and it is too hard to believe that the kings followed the policy of reuse to legitimize their rule or to seek the blessing from the predecessor kings, as was common among ancient monarchs during periods of prosperity. Both parts of the state during the 21st Dynasty were afflicted by this precarious economic-political situation, and the cost of (re)burial was insanely high that the local Tanite kings in Lower Egypt and the priest-kings in Upper Egypt could not provide the necessary funds to send long-term quarrying expeditions to extract proper sarcophagi and to cover the cost of transportation. The scarcity of the materials persisted even after the Bubastite Dynasty took power; they were unable to control the situation and adopted the approach of the Tanite kings, namely the policy of reuse, despite its apparent wealth it seemed to be insufficient. We hope that the archaeological discoveries provide the solution to this puzzle and may reveal the lost Bubastite royal necropolis, which will undoubtedly offer a compelling answer.

¹ Damarany, Ayman and Cahail, Kevin, "The sarcophagus of the High Priest of Amun, Menkheperre, from the Coptic monastery of Apa Moses at Abydos" *MDAIK* 72, 2016, 11, fig. 5-6; Payraudeau, Frédéric, "Le sarcophage de Ramsès II Remployé à Abydos!", *RdÉ* 73, 2023, 103-115.

² Dodson, Aidan "The Burials of Ahmose I", *CASAE* 41 (2010), 25, footnote 1.

³ An inventory of the royal mummies and reused coffins in which they were placed in Ismaeel, "Context Analysis of Reusing the Royal Mummies' Funeral Equipment", 368-369, Table 3.

List of Abbreviations

<i>ASAE</i>	Annales du Service des Antiquités de l'Égypte, Le Caire.
<i>BIFAO</i>	Bulletin de l'Institut français d'archéologie orientale, Le Caire.
<i>CdÉ</i>	Chronique d'Égypte, Bulletin périodique de la Fondation Égyptologique Reine Elisabeth, Bruxelles.
<i>CASAE</i>	Cahiers suppléments aux Annales du Service des Antiquités de l'Égypte, Le Caire.
<i>GM</i>	Göttinger Miszellen, Göttingen.
<i>JARCH</i>	Journal of the Faculty of Archaeology, Cairo University.
<i>JEA</i>	Journal of the Egyptian Archaeology, London.
<i>MDAIK</i>	Mitteilungen des Deutschen Archäologischen Instituts, Abt. Kairo, Wiesbaden-Mayence.
<i>MMAF</i>	Mémoires Publiés par les Membres de la Mission Archéologique Française, Le Caire.
<i>PM</i>	Bertha Porter and Rosalind Moss, <i>Topographical Bibliography of Ancient Egyptian Hieroglyphic Texts, Reliefs and Paintings</i> , 7 vols. (Oxford: Griffith Institute, 1970-1975.).
<i>RdÉ</i>	Revue d'Égyptologie, Paris-Louvain.
<i>Rec. Trav.</i>	Recueil de Travaux Relatifs à la Philologie et à l'Archéologie Égyptiennes et assyriennes, Paris.
<i>RevArch</i>	<i>Revue Archéologique</i> , Paris.

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